

Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date 30 September 2026

Team ID : SWTID-2026-3350

Project Name : PocketSmart AI – Your Smart Budget & Recommendation Assistant

Maximum Marks : 4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

For PocketSmart AI, the empathy map is used to understand the user's behaviours and attitudes while trying to manage a personal budget and make informed spending decisions. The map considers the user's goals, thoughts, feelings, environment, actions, challenges, and expected benefits. This helps the team focus on the real user experience when designing the application.

The primary user considered for this empathy map is a person who wants a simple way to understand income and expenses, create a practical budget, receive personalized spending recommendations, and adjust recommendations based on personal feedback.

PocketSmart AI – Empathy Map Canvas

User Persona: Budget-Conscious User Seeking Personalized Financial Guidance

THINK & FEEL	• Wants a budget that feels personal and realistic. • Thinks about whether current spending is aligned with the available income and budget. • Wants confidence that expenses are organized and easy to understand. • Feels motivated when recommendations match personal needs, but may feel unsure when budgeting guidance is generic.
SEE	• Sees many different budgeting methods and spending suggestions online. • Sees expense-tracking tools, savings tips, offers, and conflicting financial recommendations. • May see spending patterns that are difficult to categorize or understand. • Wants a clear dashboard with simple, organized budget and recommendation information.

HEAR	• Hears budgeting advice from family, friends, social media, and financial content. • Hears different opinions about saving, spending, budgeting, and financial priorities. • Hears encouragement to control unnecessary spending and manage money consistently. • May receive advice that is not personalized to individual income, expenses, or preferences.
SAY & DO	• Says: "I need help managing my budget." • Says: "I want to know where my money is being spent." • Enters income, budget amounts, expenses, categories, and preferences. • Reviews the budget analysis and recommendations. • Provides feedback or updated information when recommendations need to be changed.
PAINS	• Difficulty creating a suitable budget from income and expenses. • Too many generic budgeting and spending recommendations. • Uncertainty about spending categories and how much remains available. • Difficulty knowing how to adjust spending after reviewing the budget. • Financial information and advice may be scattered across different sources.
GAINS	• Receives a structured and personalized budget summary. • Gets spending and budgeting recommendations in one place. • Can review remaining budget and expense information clearly. • Can provide feedback or updated information about financial needs. • Receives updated recommendations that reflect the available information. • Gains a simple and organized budgeting experience.

Key User Insight

The user needs more than a one-time budget summary. They need clear personalized financial guidance and an easy way to communicate changes in spending needs or preferences so the recommendations can be adjusted. This insight supports PocketSmart AI's feedback-based personalization flow.

**Financial Details → Budget Analysis → Personalized Recommendations → Feedback /
Updated Information → Updated Recommendations**